

Scams • Chapter 3

Case files

Last checked 3 November 2026 • 9 minutes to read

Scam patterns told as case files, from the first message to the cost. None of them is a real person or a real event, and each one ends with what to do.

Verified | Reported | Vivian's field notes

This chapter is not advice for your situation.

In 30 seconds

- A case file follows one scam pattern from the first message to the cost and to the way out.
- No case here is a real person or a single real event. Each is a pattern, rebuilt so that nobody can be recognised.
- Most of the harm comes from keys, payment routes and tools, not from one villain.
- A password, a login code or remote control of your device is never part of the game.
- If you already sent, stop, keep the proof and tell someone you trust.

You will learn

- The six questions every case file answers.
- The verification fee, from the first message to the vanish.
- Why a promise is never a safeguard when someone asks for a key to your accounts.
- Why a payment route that is not yours can take a balance with it.
- What to weigh before you post a warning about anyone.

A case file is a story with the names taken out. I tell each one from the side of the person who receives the message, because that is the only seat from which the pattern can still be refused. Read them once, calmly. You will know the second one on the day it arrives.

— Vivian

How to read a case file

Every case file answers the same six questions: what it looks like, who it targets, why it works, what it costs, what to do, and where to report it. Run them on any offer, including one that is not in this chapter.

No case here describes a real person or a single real event. Each is a pattern, rebuilt from its parts. Press describes the scene as flooded with scammers who use stolen photos. Reported The authors of a published study flag fraud, identity fraud included, as a risk that remains. Verified One victim quoted by the press said the emotional hurt outweighed the financial loss. Reported

Case 1: the verification fee

How it starts. A new account writes first, with flattering words and a set of images that looks expensive. In 2DFD the images may be stolen or generated art, so quality proves nothing about who runs the account. ◑ Press reports fake accounts that reply to subs who post about findom and ask them to send a direct message. ◎ Reported

How it works (invented example)

1. **Contact**
   The account writes first and moves fast.
2. **The hook**
   “I only take serious subs.”
3. **The fee**
   “Pay a verification fee to prove you are real.”
4. **The vanish**
   The account blocks you, or asks for a second fee.

Who it targets. New subs, and anyone who has just posted about wanting a dom. The scam has a low barrier to entry. ◎ Reported

Why it works. A fee to prove that you are real proves nothing, because nobody can check what it was for. It works on the wish to be accepted and on the fear of losing the chance. ◑ Some real dommes also ask for payment first, to keep time-wasters away. ◎ Reported The tell is a payment with no purpose except to prove that you are serious, in a form that is hard to reverse.

What it costs. The first fee, then a second ask under another name: insurance, an unlock fee, refund processing. Gift cards and crypto are hard to reverse once the funds are used. A card issuer, a bank or a gift-card company can sometimes block or reverse a payment that is reported fast, so contact them at once.

Red flags

The tells

- Payment comes before any conversation, and it is described as proof of something.
- The fee is asked in gift cards or crypto, not through a platform that keeps a record.
- A timer is attached: now, or the offer is gone forever.
- Simple personal questions get no answer in the account's own words.

Counter. Send nothing before a real conversation. A real dom can wait an hour. The full list is in Spot a fake dom.

Where to report. On the platform where you met the account, with the messages and receipts attached. The longer path back is If you already sent.

If you already sent

1. Stop sending, even to “unlock a refund”.
2. Keep the messages and the payment receipts.
3. Contact your bank, card issuer or the gift-card company at once, and ask whether the payment can be blocked.
4. Report the account on the platform where you met.
5. Tell someone you trust what happened.

Case 2: the access request

How it starts. A dom asks for the login of a second social account, then for the code that arrives on your phone. Sometimes it is a remote-desktop session. It is framed as proof of loyalty or as the price of keeping the bond.

Why it works. It arrives at an emotional moment, wrapped in reassurance. A spoken promise protects nothing, and a login code lets another person take over the account at once. Public guidance tells people not to hand control of a computer or phone to a stranger. Verified A remote-access vendor says the same about anyone you do not know or trust. Verified In 2DFD nobody knows who is behind the character, so every dom is a stranger in this sense.

What it costs. The account, the private messages in it and your name on whatever comes next. Shared logins remove the independent space a sub needs to say no or to leave.

Spot the flags (invented example)

Tap every message that shows a red flag. There are three.

Example conversation. Invented for this exercise.

Them

Before this goes any further, I need proof that you are honest with me.

You

How can I show that?

Them

Open a remote session so I can look. You can close it whenever you like.

Red flag 1. Remote control of your machine is a classic scam step, and the promise that you can close it protects nothing.

You

I would rather not.

Them

Then give me the code that arrives on your phone.

Red flag 2. A one-time code lets another person take the account over at once.

At least the login of your other account.

Red flag 3. A login is a key to your identity, not a proof of honesty.

You

No. I do not share access, and I offer nothing from my accounts.

Vivian's field notes

In my experience the request almost always comes at a weak moment: late at night, after a quarrel, after a lapse. The timing is part of the method. A real dom never needs your password, and an honest question can be answered in words, so you owe nothing from your accounts.

What to do. Refuse, offer nothing from your accounts, and state your own limit once. If the answer is more pressure, that is the answer. *Where to report.* On the platform where you met the account, and to the provider of the account if any code was shared.

Case 3: the tool that says one thing and does another

How it starts. A page promises a one-click helper. Everything stays local, nothing is paid unless a special mode is switched on, updates are automatic. A page is a promise. The behaviour is in the code.

Why it works. Most people read the page and not the permissions. Chrome shows a permission warning at install. It also disables an extension after an update that adds a warning-level permission, until you accept it. Verified Read the permission list first. Check a tool before you install it shows how, and Fake tools shows the patterns.

A worked example in reverse. A first reading of a tool can suggest the worst, and a full reading can show a narrower risk. A tool whose updater can replace any file, kept next to login tokens on the same computer, could take everything with one update. That is a different verdict from "malware".

Vivian's field notes

A false alarm costs trust as much as a missed one. Read the whole source, the updater and every network call included, before you use the word malware. A tool that does no harm today and could do harm after one update is a finding, not an accusation.

What it costs. Whatever the tool is allowed to reach: accounts and payments. *What to do.* Install nothing that you cannot explain in a sentence. *Where to report.* To the store that distributes it.

Case 4: the payment route that is not yours

How it starts. A dom collects through a payment service. Some personas misdescribe their activity to a payment service, which breaks its terms and is why balances freeze. Or the platform that carries her wishlist loses its payment partner and closes. Either way, the money sits on a route that somebody else owns.

Why it matters to you. A payment service can close an account that it finds described falsely and hold the balance, and your payment goes with it. Terms differ from one service to the next and they change. Anonymity ends where the money lands, because a payout is tied to a real identity.

Red flags

Signs that the route is shaky

- She asks you to describe your payment as something it is not.
- She pushes you to pay outside the platform's visible route.
- She avoids plain words about money and about what a gift buys.
- She promises results that a gift cannot buy.

Counter. Say what the payment is, in plain words. If a dom asks you to say it is something else, stop. The label can freeze her money and yours.

What it costs. A frozen balance and a trail tied to a real identity. *Where to report.* To the platform, if a dom asks you to mislabel a payment. A dom who needs a legitimate route should read Getting paid.

Case 5: three short patterns

Short patterns, from the side of the person who receives them

What they say or do

1 A friendly dom writes to you privately and asks for “a small thing” the dom you serve must not hear about

The counter

Secrecy is the part that does the work. Keep one cap across everyone you pay, and tell the dom you serve.

What they say or do

2 Someone shows you a screenshot of a chat to make you doubt a dom

The counter

Anyone can edit the text of a web page and capture the result. Ask the dom directly, and do not leave over a screenshot alone.

What they say or do

3 A stranger steers you to a private messaging app with an offer of cheap or free video

The counter

Stay on the platform where you met, ignore it and report it.

Case 6: the click-to-post chain and the display account

How it starts. A chain of links drafts a post on your own account each time you click. The drafts escalate from a playful label to a confession to a payment announcement with a link. You publish the text yourself, under your own identity.

A close cousin is the display account: a dom takes over a sub's public account and turns it into a showcase of his sends. Treat a request to hand over a social account as a loss of control over your own identity, not as a game feature.

Before you publish a draft that someone else wrote

1. Read the whole draft, not only the first line.
2. Ask whether you would sign it with your own name in a year.
3. Do not publish from an account tied to your real identity.
4. Decline the next link in the chain. Declining costs nothing.

Names, call-outs and proof

When you have been hurt, you may want to post a warning. A public warning can protect others, but weak evidence invites claims of defamation, and the person you name may have nothing to do with it. There is no foolproof way to screen out scammers. Reported

Myth

If I know the handle, I can say who is behind the persona.

Fact

Linking a handle to a real person without that person's own words is doxxing. It also invites retaliation, such as mass reports from accounts the other side controls.

A warning, or not

An account took a small amount from you and vanished. You hold the messages. A friend urges you to post the account's name and its images on a public thread tonight.

A Post everything now

Not this one. The anger is fair, but the images may belong to a real person whose art or photos were stolen. You could name someone who had nothing to do with it. See Stolen art and persona theft.

B Report on the platform, keep the proof, and describe the pattern without the name

The right answer. This protects others and keeps your evidence intact. Share the pattern privately with people you trust.

C Say nothing and tell no one

Not this one. You carry it alone and the platform cannot act. Tell at least one person you trust, and report.

Six questions for any offer

Ask these every time

Can I follow the payment afterwards?

Why it matters

A route that keeps a record for both sides protects both. Gift cards and crypto are hard to reverse once the funds are used.

Did money come before conversation?

Why it matters

Some real doms do ask first. A payment named as proof of something is the tell.

Is there a timer?

Why it matters

A timer exists to stop you from thinking. Wait an hour, then a day.

Does it need a key to my life?

Why it matters

A password, a login code or remote access is never part of the game.

Would I sign this post with my own name?

Why it matters

If not, do not publish it from your own account.

Does the tool do only what its page says?

Why it matters

Read the permissions before you install, and remove what you cannot stop.

Remember it

1. A case file is a pattern, not a person. Run its six questions on any offer.
2. A fee to prove that you are real proves nothing.
3. A password, a login code or remote access is never part of the game.
4. A payment route you do not own can vanish with the balance.
5. Read a draft before you publish it, and report before you accuse.

Check it

Every claim with its evidence level and its sources.

Evidence levels

Verified	Checked against the original source.
Reported	Stated by a serious secondary source read in full.
Community	Widely said in the scene; no document proves it.
Vivian's field notes	First-hand experience, not a study.

Unverified

Plausible, not proven yet.

1 Each is a pattern, rebuilt from its parts.

Vivian's field notes

2 Press describes the scene as flooded with scammers who use stolen photos.

Reported

Financial Domination Has a Scamming Problem (https://www.vice.com/en/article/financial-domination-has-a-scamming-problem)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260827104045/https://www.vice.com/en/article/financial-domination-has-a-scamming-problem/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

3 The authors of a published study flag fraud, identity fraud included, as a risk that remains.

Verified

Findommes, Cybermediated Sex Work, and Rinsing (McCracken and Brooks-Gordon, Sexuality Research and Social Policy 18(4), 837-854, DOI 10.1007/s13178-021-00609-3) (https://www.ebi.ac.uk/europepmc/webservices/rest/PMC8418458/fullTextXML)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261016030740/https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8418458/)

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4 One victim quoted by the press said the emotional hurt outweighed the financial loss.

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5 In 2DFD the images may be stolen or generated art, so quality proves nothing about who runs the account.

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6 Press reports fake accounts that reply to subs who post about findom and ask them to send a direct message.

Reported

The Curse of the Fake Financial Dominatrix (https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/the-curse-of-the-fake-financial-dominatrix)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260511185644/https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/the-curse-of-the-fake-financial-dominatrix)

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7 The scam has a low barrier to entry.

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14 It arrives at an emotional moment, wrapped in reassurance.

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15 A spoken promise protects nothing, and a login code lets another person take over the account at once.

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16 Public guidance tells people not to hand control of a computer or phone to a stranger.

Verified

IC3 Issues Alert on Tech Support Fraud (https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/alerts/2018/03/29/ic3-issues-alert-tech-support-fraud)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20250716102123/https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/alerts/2018/03/29/ic3-issues-alert-tech-support-fraud)

Accessed 3 November 2026

17 A remote-access vendor says the same about anyone you do not know or trust.

Verified

TeamViewer and scamming (https://www.teamviewer.com/en/global/support/knowledge-base/teamviewer-remote/security/teamviewer-and-scamming/)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260519191922/https://www.teamviewer.com/en/global/support/knowledge-base/teamviewer-remote/security/teamviewer-and-scamming/)

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23 The behaviour is in the code.

Vivian's field notes

24 It also disables an extension after an update that adds a warning-level permission, until you accept it.

Verified

Permission warnings (Chrome for Developers, extensions documentation) (https://developer.chrome.com/docs/extensions/develop/concepts/permission-warnings)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261102194346/https://developer.chrome.com/docs/extensions/develop/concepts/permission-warnings)

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34 Keep one cap across everyone you pay, and tell the dom you serve.

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35 Ask the dom directly, and do not leave over a screenshot alone.

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37 The drafts escalate from a playful label to a confession to a payment announcement with a link.

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43 It also invites retaliation, such as mass reports from accounts the other side controls.

Vivian's field notes

Free, confidential helplines exist in most countries.

Find a helpline →

Nothing here is financial, legal or medical advice for your situation.